

# ROXANA GONZALEZ

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Citizenship: United States

## EDUCATION

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|-------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|
| Expected May 2027 | Ph.D. in Economics, University of South Carolina                |
| May 2022          | B.A. in Economics, University of Tennessee ( <i>Cum Laude</i> ) |

## FIELDS OF INTEREST

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Urban Economics, Public Economics, Large Language Models

## JOB MARKET PAPER

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“Outcomes of Property Tax Regressivity”

Sole-Authored

**Abstract:** Tax assessments are regressive with respect to house price for owner-occupied single-family homes in the United States, translating to higher effective tax rates for owners of cheaper homes (Amornsiripanitch 2024; McMillen & Singh 2019). I study whether this regressive property tax structure leads to worse outcomes for these households using a panel of property tax liabilities and transactions for all owner-occupied housing units in Mecklenburg County, North Carolina. Using Mecklenburg’s seven-year reassessment cycle to capture large changes in tax assessment values, I find that bottom-quartile homes sell at an 18 percent discount and see 64 percent more foreclosure filings two-to-three years after a reassessment, on average. I instrument for effective tax rates with years from reassessment to capture the share of the reassessment effect attributable to the property tax regressivity. I find that over half of the effects on sales prices and foreclosure filings can be explained by differences in effective tax rate changes post-reassessment. The effect is not driven by local unemployment cycles nor housing market trends specific to all bottom quartile-homes, suggesting that differential property tax burdens disproportionately affect owners of cheaper homes.

## RESEARCH PAPERS

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“Opportunity Zones & Housing Supply”

Sole-Authored

*Under Review, Journal of Urban Economics*

“What Can LLMs Tell Us About the ETI?”

with Jason DeBacker and Max Ghenis

“Opportunity for Affordability: Tax Incentives and Rental Housing Markets”

Sole-Authored

*Recipient of the Best Third-Year Paper Award*

## WORK IN PROGRESS

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“The Effectiveness of Local Flavored E-Cigarette Bans”

with Kara Jones and Danna Thomas

## HONORS, GRANTS AND SCHOLARSHIPS

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| 2026      | SPARC Graduate Research Grant (\$5,000), University of South Carolina Office of Research                                         |
| 2026      | Graduate School Travel Grant (\$800), University of South Carolina Graduate School                                               |
| 2025      | Southeastern Annual Economic Conference Graduate Student Award (\$1,000)                                                         |
| 2025      | Melayne Morgan McInnes Memorial Award for Best Third-Year Paper (\$1,000), University of South Carolina Moore School of Business |
| 2022      | Summer Program Scholar, American Economic Association (AEA)                                                                      |
| 2018–2022 | Pledge Scholar, University of Tennessee                                                                                          |

## PRESENTATIONS

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| 2026 | American Economic Association (AEA) Summer Mentoring Pipeline Conference; American Real Estate and Urban Economics Association (AREUEA) International Conference ( <i>Accepted</i> ) |
| 2025 | Southern Economics Association (SEA) Annual Conference; American Economic Association (AEA) Summer Mentoring Pipeline Conference                                                     |
| 2024 | Association for Public Policy and Management (APPAM) Annual Conference; American Economic Association (AEA) Summer Mentoring Pipeline Conference                                     |

## TEACHING POSITIONS

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Department of Economics, University of South Carolina Moore School of Business

### **Instructor of Record**

Spring 2026                      Introduction to Economics

### **Teaching Assistant**

Spring 2026                      Professor Lois Miller

Spring 2025                      Professor Sang Min Lee

Spring–Fall 2024                Professor Danna Thomas

Fall 2023                         Professor Tamara Sheldon

## RESEARCH POSTIONS

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|-------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2025–2026   | Research Assistant to Professor Jason DeBacker, University of South Carolina |
| Summer 2025 | Research Assistant to Professor Crystal Zhan, University of South Carolina   |
| Spring 2025 | Research Assistant to Professor Jason DeBacker, University of South Carolina |
| 2024        | Research Assistant to Professor Danna Thomas, University of South Carolina   |
| Fall 2023   | Research Assistant to Professor Crystal Zhan, University of South Carolina   |
| 2022–2023   | Research Assistant to Professor Jason DeBacker, University of South Carolina |
| Spring 2022 | Research Assistant to Professor Kin Blackburn, University of South Carolina  |
| 2021–2022   | Research Assistant to Professor Maria Padilla-Romo, University of Tennessee  |

## RELEVANT EXPERIENCE

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|-------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Aug. 2025–present | Workforce Data Scientist (part-time), South Carolina Department of Employment and Workforce |
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## PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

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|------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2026 | Job Market Boot Camp, American Economic Association (AEA) Summer Mentoring Pipeline Conference                        |
| 2025 | Summer School in Urban Economics, Urban Economics Association, Tufts University                                       |
| 2024 | Applied Data Analytics Training, Coleridge Initiative (confidential micro-data, record linkage, and machine learning) |
| 2022 | Summer Training Program, American Economic Association (AEA)                                                          |

## SKILLS

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**Statistical Software / Programming:** Python, SQL, Stata, R  
**Quantitative Methods:** Causal inference, regression, predictive modeling, machine learning  
**Data Skills:** Collection, cleaning, validation, documentation, and dissemination of large datasets  
**Languages:** English (fluent), Spanish (fluent)  
**Service:** First-Generation Graduate Mentor, University of South Carolina, 2024–2025

## SERVICE

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First-Generation Graduate Mentor, University of South Carolina, 2024–2025

## REFERENCES

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| <b>Dr. Jason DeBacker</b><br>Associate Professor of Economics<br>University of South Carolina<br>jason.debacker@moore.sc.edu<br>(770) 289-0340<br>Relationship: Graduate Research Advisor | <b>Dr. Danna Thomas</b><br>Assistant Professor of Economics<br>University of South Carolina<br>danna.thomas@moore.sc.edu<br>(256) 452-7415<br>Relationship: Faculty Mentor |
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